

Real Estate Transaction Deadline Kit

Every deal on one tracker with its next deadline visible, every contingency dated with days remaining and automatic flags, every file showing its missing documents each Monday, and every closing converted into one implemented lesson. The practice runs on a weekly routine that ends with sent communications rather than mental notes.

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Companion files: Excel workbook, editable Word templates, README.

Real Estate Transaction Deadline Kit

Implementation Guide for Solo Agents and Transaction Coordinators

This guide shows a solo real estate agent or transaction coordinator how to run several deals at once without losing track of a single deadline. A typical residential transaction carries 50 to 70 tasks between contract and close, and a handful of those tasks are contingency deadlines that can end the deal if they pass without action: inspection objection windows, appraisal review periods, and loan approval dates. Miss one by a day and the buyer may lose leverage, the seller may gain a right to cancel, or the file may fall apart entirely. This kit gives you four tools that prevent that: a multi-deal tracker with deadline formulas that flag what is due, a document checklist that shows what is missing on every file, a contingency log covering inspection, appraisal, and loan milestones, and a post-close review that turns each closing into a lesson for the next file.

This kit covers agent-side operations: how you track, remind, collect, and close. It does not advise buyers on whether to buy, what to offer, or whether to waive a contingency. It is not legal advice, and contract rules, contingency defaults, and deadline-counting methods vary by state and by contract form. Verify your state contract rules locally and have your broker review your procedures before you rely on them. That warning appears here, in the limitations section, in the listing disclaimer, and in the contingency template, because it is the most important sentence in this kit.

You need the Excel workbook in this kit, the three Word templates, and one weekly review habit. Most users are fully operational within two weeks. Section 4 gives you a 60-minute quick start. Section 21 gives you a day-by-day 14-day setup plan.

1. Who This Kit Is For and Who It Is Not For

This kit is for solo residential agents carrying 2 to 10 active transactions, and for transaction coordinators supporting one or several agents. If your desk looks like a row of folders each with its own cast of lender, inspector, appraiser, title officer, co-op agent, buyer, and seller, and every folder has different dates that all feel equally urgent, this kit organizes that exact desk. It also fits small teams where one person owns file administration for everyone else.

It is not for buyers managing their own purchase. Nothing here tells a buyer what to negotiate or which contingency to keep. It is not for attorneys, and it does not replace attorney or broker review of any contract, addendum, or notice. It is not for commercial transactions, auctions, short sales with lender-approval chains, or new construction with builder-controlled addenda, all of which carry structures this kit does not model. It is not legal advice in any form, and it does not interpret contract language. If a deadline's meaning is unclear on a live file, ask your broker or counsel the same day. Do not guess from a template.

2. How To Use This Kit

The kit contains this guide, one Excel workbook with four sheets, and three Word templates. Read sections 4 through 8 first, then open the Deal Tracker sheet and enter your live files. Add each file's contingency dates to the Contingency Log, mark collected documents on the Document Checklist, and run the weekly review in section 14 every Monday without exception. The post-close review in section 16 happens after each closing while the details are fresh.

The workbook computes date math for you. Enter a contract date and a contingency period in days, and the deadline computes itself. Flags compare deadlines against today and label each item as current, due soon, or overdue. Your job is to enter dates the day they are set, update statuses the day they change, and trust the Monday review to surface what needs action. A tracker updated weekly catches problems early. A tracker updated when someone remembers is decoration.

3. Quick Start: Your First 60 Minutes

Minute 0 to 15: open the Deal Tracker sheet and enter every active transaction on one row each. Deal ID can be any short unique code, for example D-01 onward. Enter the property address, which side you represent, the contract or effective date, the scheduled close date, and the current status from the controlled list: Active, Pending Docs, Clear to Close, Closed, or On Hold. Do not invent new status words. Controlled wording keeps filters and reviews reliable across months.

Minute 15 to 30: for each active deal, enter its three core contingency deadlines in the Contingency Log: inspection, appraisal, and loan. Use the exact dates from the signed contract and any addenda, not from memory and not from an email summary. If a contract states a period in days rather than a date, compute the calendar date using the deadline rules in section 8 and your state counting method, then enter the resulting date and note the source, for example per contract section 8 plus addendum 1.

Minute 30 to 45: open the Document Checklist sheet and mark what you already hold for each file. Standard residential files need the signed contract with all addenda, pre-approval or proof of funds, earnest money receipt, seller disclosures, inspection report when ordered, appraisal report when received, loan commitment when issued, title commitment, closing disclosure when available, and HOA

documents where applicable. Mark each as received or missing with dates. The missing items are your action list for the week.

Minute 45 to 60: set your weekly review appointment with yourself. Pick Monday morning, block 60 minutes, and run the review in section 14 on your real files today. Send every reminder and request the review surfaces before lunch. You are now operating the system. The rest of this guide makes you fast and consistent at it.

4. Background: How Deals Die on Deadlines

Deals rarely die from one dramatic event. They die from small lapses that stack. An inspection objection deadline passes on a Friday afternoon without a notice delivered, and on Monday the buyer has lost a right the contract gave them. An appraisal comes in low and nobody calendars the appraisal review window, so the renegotiation starts from weakness instead of from a timely notice. A loan commitment date arrives with the file still missing two conditions, and the extension request goes out late, which costs the buyer leverage and sometimes the rate lock. Each lapse looks minor in isolation. Together they read as disorganization, and disorganization makes every party on the other side of the table negotiate harder.

Volume makes this worse in a predictable way. One file with 50 to 70 tasks is manageable from memory for about a week. Three files with different inspection dates, different lenders, and different personalities is where memory starts dropping items. Five or more files without a written system is where dropped items become dropped deals. The failure is rarely effort. Agents who lose deadlines usually work long hours. The failure is architecture: dates live in emails, texts, sticky notes, and memory, with no single list that shows every deadline across every file sorted by urgency.

Contingency deadlines deserve special respect because they are rights with expiration dates. An inspection contingency is the buyer's bargained right to object, negotiate, or exit within a window. An appraisal contingency protects against paying above appraised value without a further decision. A financing contingency conditions performance on loan approval. When these windows close without the required notice or action, rights lapse by the contract's own terms, and no amount of diligence afterward restores them. This kit treats contingency dates as the highest-priority data in the file, reviewed first every Monday, flagged automatically by formula, and confirmed in writing with the relevant party before they arrive.

The second structural risk is document drift. Files collect documents unevenly: the contract arrives day one, disclosures trickle in, the inspection report lands as a large PDF nobody reads fully, the appraisal appears two days before anyone expected it, and the closing disclosure arrives with numbers that differ from the last estimate. Without a checklist that names every expected document and marks its absence, missing items surface at the worst moment, usually the day before closing. The checklist converts that panic into a routine: every file shows its gaps every Monday, and gaps get chased while there is still time.

5. The Method: Four Linked Tools

The system has four tools keyed by Deal ID. The Deal Tracker is the master list: one row per transaction with the address, side represented, contract date, close date, computed days to close,

status, and the next upcoming deadline with its date. This is the sheet you open every morning. It answers the only three questions that matter at the start of the day: which files are active, what is due next on each, and what is already late.

The Contingency Log holds one row per contingency per deal: inspection, appraisal, loan, and any others your contracts include, such as sale-of-home, HOA review, or title and survey objection periods. Each row carries the deadline date, the auto-computed days remaining, a status, the date satisfied where applicable, and notes. The log is the early-warning panel. Sorted by days remaining, it shows the whole practice's risk in one view.

The Document Checklist holds one row per expected document per deal, marked required or not applicable, received or missing, with the receipt date. It is the completeness panel. A file with all rows received is ready to move. A file with missing rows has a visible, assignable action list.

The Post-Close Review holds one row per closed deal with the contract and close dates, computed days to close, what slipped, the lesson, the follow-up action, and whether the follow-up is done. It is the learning panel. Reviewed quarterly, it shows which deadline types slip most, which lenders and vendors run late, and which of your own habits need work. The four tools feed each other: the tracker points at the log, the log points at the checklist, and the review improves all three.

6. Setting Up the Multi-Deal Tracker

Enter one row per transaction. The columns are Deal ID, property address, side represented, contract date, close date, days to close computed by formula, status, next deadline name, next deadline date, and priority. Side represented uses a short controlled vocabulary: Buyer or Seller. Status uses the controlled list from section 3. Priority is a simple High, Normal, or Low that you set by judgment each Monday, considering days to close, open contingencies, and missing documents. Priority is the only subjective column on the sheet, and reviewing it weekly keeps it honest.

The next-deadline fields are updated during the Monday review from the Contingency Log: look at each deal's open contingencies, take the nearest date, and copy its name and date into the tracker row. This takes about a minute per file and gives the tracker its power as a morning dashboard. An alternative some coordinators prefer is to leave the next-deadline fields as the single source and skip the copy step, but that scatters deadline truth across two sheets. The log holds every contingency. The tracker shows the nearest one. Keep that division clean.

Days to close is a simple subtraction, close date minus contract date, computed by formula in the first example row with notes explaining how to copy it down. It tells you the file's total runway at a glance and feeds the post-close comparison of planned versus actual timelines. When close dates move, and they often do, update the close date cell the day the amendment is signed. A tracker with a stale close date misleads every downstream judgment about urgency.

Addresses in the tracker are working identifiers, not mailing labels. Enter enough to identify the file unambiguously, for example street number, street, and city. Keep client personal details out of the workbook beyond what file administration requires, and store the workbook where your broker's data policies require. If your office uses a transaction management platform, the workbook complements it rather than replacing it: the platform holds the documents, the workbook holds the cross-file urgency view that platforms often bury three clicks deep.

7. Deadline Formulas: How the Workbook Computes Dates

Three kinds of date math run the system. First, deadline computation: a contingency stated as N days from a trigger date lands on the trigger date plus N days, adjusted for your state counting rules. The workbook demonstrates the plain calendar version, deadline equals trigger plus N, using ordinary date addition. Your state or contract form may exclude the trigger day, skip weekends and holidays for certain notices, or define receipt differently for delivered notices. Those adjustments are judgment you apply before entering the date, not formula magic. Enter the correct date with a note citing its source. The formula then tracks it faithfully.

Second, days remaining: deadline date minus today, computed with the TODAY function so it refreshes every time the workbook opens. The contingency log's Days Remaining column uses exactly this, and the Status column layers the flag logic on top: past dates read overdue, dates within the coming 7 days read due soon, satisfied items read satisfied regardless of date, and everything else reads on track. The 7-day window is tighter than the maintenance-style 30-day window used in equipment kits because contract contingencies move faster and carry harder edges. Tune it only with reason and note any change.

Third, elapsed and duration math: days to close as close minus contract, days open on issues as today minus discovery, and post-close actuals as close minus contract again for comparison. All are plain subtractions that Excel, LibreOffice Calc, and Google Sheets handle identically. Enter dates in ISO format YYYY-MM-DD, for example 2026-10-05, which every spreadsheet parses unambiguously and which sorts correctly as text or as dates.

Two cautions that prevent most formula failures. One, never type a date with leading or trailing spaces, and never enter a date as text with an apostrophe prefix or a month name with a typo. A text-that-looks-like-a-date breaks every downstream subtraction silently or loudly depending on the program, and either way your flags lie. Two, the TODAY function follows the computer clock. If you open the workbook on a machine with the wrong system date, every flag is wrong. Check the system date when flags look surprising before doubting the formulas.

8. Counting Rules and Local Verification

This section is short because its message is a warning, not a technique. Deadline-counting rules vary. Some states count calendar days including weekends for contract periods but require notices to be delivered by a business-day rule. Some contract forms exclude the effective date from the count. Some start specific periods on receipt or on acceptance rather than on the effective date. Holidays, electronic delivery timing, and time-of-day cutoffs all vary. This kit cannot state your rule, because your rule lives in your state contract form, your broker policy, and your state license law together.

Verify locally before you rely on any deadline in this kit. Read the contract form's own definitions section for how days are counted. Ask your broker how the office applies those definitions to inspection, appraisal, and loan periods. Confirm any change when forms update, because counting language changes between form revisions and offices miss the change. Write your office counting method on one card, keep it with the contingency template, and apply it identically to every file. Consistency within the correct local rule is the entire game. A sophisticated spreadsheet applying the wrong counting rule is worse than a paper calendar applying the right one, because the spreadsheet

looks authoritative while being wrong.

When a deadline's meaning is genuinely unclear on a live file, escalate the same day to your broker or counsel. Common triggers for escalation: conflicting dates between contract and addendum, ambiguous receipt of a notice, a contingency whose satisfaction condition is vaguely worded, and any deadline that falls on a weekend or holiday where the contract is silent on the shift. Log the question and the answer received in the contingency notes column with the date. That note is your proof of diligence if the timeline is ever questioned.

9. Document Checklist System

The checklist names every document a standard residential file is expected to contain and marks each as required, received, or not applicable with dates. The working standard list: signed contract with all addenda and initials, pre-approval letter or proof of funds, earnest money receipt, seller disclosure package, lead-based paint disclosure for applicable vintage, HOA or condo documents where applicable, inspection report and any specialist reports, inspection objection or resolution notices, appraisal report, appraisal-related notices, loan commitment letter, title commitment, survey where applicable, closing disclosure, and final walkthrough confirmation. Mark not applicable explicitly rather than leaving blanks. A blank could mean missing or could mean irrelevant, and the difference matters at 5 p.m. the day before closing.

Work the checklist in three passes. Pass one at contract acceptance: confirm the contract package is complete with every page, initial, addendum, and signature, because incomplete contract packages cause a surprising share of downstream confusion. Pass two at each contingency milestone: when inspection is ordered, expect the report within the local norm and chase it before the objection window narrows. Pass three in the final ten days: title, closing disclosure, funds, and walkthrough, in that order of sensitivity. The checklist's Status formula flags any required-but-unreceived document as missing automatically, so the Monday review shows every gap without hunting.

Chase missing documents with dated requests and log each request. A request log with three dated follow-ups and no response tells a very different story from a vague memory of having asked. State what you need, by when, and why the date matters: the inspection report is needed by Thursday so the objection notice can be prepared before Friday's deadline. People respond to dated, reasoned requests faster than to general nudges. Copy your broker on escalations per office policy, and keep every substantive document conversation in writing.

10. Contingency Log: Inspection

The inspection contingency is usually the first deadline after contract acceptance and the most operationally intense. The sequence runs: order the inspection immediately at acceptance, attend or receive the report, read the full report rather than the summary alone, decide with your client and broker whether to accept, object, negotiate repairs or credits, or terminate per the contract, prepare the required notice in the required form, and deliver it before the deadline with proof of delivery. Every step needs a calendar position, not just the final deadline, because a report that arrives the morning of the objection deadline leaves no time to draft a proper notice.

Log the inspection contingency as its own row with the deadline, and use the notes column for the sub-milestones: ordered date, scheduled date, report received date, and notice sent date. When the report reveals specialist issues such as roof, foundation, mold, sewer, or electrical concerns, log each specialist follow-up as its own dated note and confirm the follow-up fits inside the window or that an extension is negotiated before the window closes. Extensions must be signed before expiration. A verbal agreement to extend, undocumented, is not an extension.

Read reports completely. Summaries highlight major items and bury the items that become major later, such as aging water heaters, double-tapped breakers, or prior repairs of unknown quality. Flag every safety item regardless of cost, because safety items carry weight in negotiation and in later disclosure. Keep the full report in the file permanently. If the deal closes, the report becomes the buyer's maintenance roadmap. If the deal terminates, the report and the timely notice are your proof of proper exercise of the contingency.

11. Contingency Log: Appraisal

The appraisal contingency protects value. The sequence runs: lender orders the appraisal, appraiser visits, report issues, parties review against contract price, and buyer decides per the contract whether to proceed, renegotiate, add funds, or exit where the contingency allows. Your operational job is to track the order date, the expected return window per local norms, the actual receipt date, and the review deadline, and to make sure the buyer's decision and any required notice land inside the window.

Low appraisals need same-day triage. Read the report for comparable selection, adjustments, and factual errors such as wrong bedroom count, missed recent updates, or incorrect square footage. Factual errors can support a reconsideration request through the lender with evidence. Weak comparable selection can sometimes be addressed with additional closed sales data supplied properly through channels the lender accepts. None of this is legal advice or appraisal practice. It is file administration: getting the right documents to the right party quickly with dates logged. Log every submission and response with dates in the contingency notes.

Calendar discipline matters because appraisal timing interacts with the loan contingency. A late appraisal compresses loan review, and compressed loan review produces last-minute conditions. When the appraisal is ordered, ask the lender for the expected return date in writing and log it. If the return passes that date by more than a few business days, escalate in writing and log the escalation. Silence from the appraisal pipeline is information, and it should trigger action while options remain open, not after they close.

12. Contingency Log: Loan and Financing

The financing contingency conditions the buyer's performance on obtaining the loan described in the contract. The operational chain is long: application, disclosures, document collection, underwriting, conditions, appraisal coordination, commitment, clear to close, and funding. Your tracker cannot manage underwriting, but it can manage visibility: log the application date, the commitment deadline, the commitment receipt date, and every condition request with its response date. A loan file with dated condition traffic is a managed file. A loan file with no dates until the week of closing is a surprise waiting to happen.

Chase conditions early and in writing. Lenders request documents in batches, and each batch restarts waiting time. When a condition list arrives, forward it to the buyer the same day with a plain-language cover note stating exactly what is needed and by when, and log the forwarding date. Follow up before the stated need date, not after. Buyers deprioritize document requests they do not understand, so translate each request into concrete action: two most recent pay stubs as PDFs, not screenshots, by Thursday noon, because underwriting reviews Friday. Concrete beats general every time.

Watch the commitment deadline as the hard edge. If commitment will not issue by the deadline, the contract's own provisions govern what happens next: extension, notice, or termination rights depending on your form and state. This is exactly the moment for broker or counsel guidance, not template improvisation. Log the guidance received and act on it the same day. Rate locks add a parallel clock. Note the lock expiration alongside the commitment deadline, because a lock expiring before closing creates cost pressure that distorts every other decision. Both dates belong in the contingency log where the Monday review cannot miss them.

13. Other Contingencies Worth Logging

Beyond the big three, log anything your contract makes time-sensitive. Sale-of-home contingencies carry their own marketing, offer, and closing milestones that must be tracked as dates, not hopes. HOA and condo review periods start on document receipt, so log the receipt date the day documents arrive and compute the review deadline from it. Title and survey objection periods need the commitment receipt date, the review completion date, and the objection notice date if issues arise. Each gets its own contingency row with the same status and days-remaining machinery.

Do not let secondary contingencies hide inside notes. A row in the log gets flagged, sorted, and reviewed. A sentence inside a notes cell gets read once and forgotten. The cost of an extra row is seconds. The cost of a missed HOA objection window can be a buyer bound to a property with restrictions never reviewed. When in doubt, create the row.

14. Weekly Deal Review Routine

Every Monday, work every active file in the same order. One, open the Deal Tracker and confirm statuses, close dates, and priorities are current. Two, sort the Contingency Log by days remaining and handle every overdue item first, then every due-soon item. Overdue means action today: notice, call, escalation, or broker consult. Due soon means scheduled action with a named owner and a date before the deadline. Three, review the Document Checklist per file and send every missing-document request the review surfaces, with dated reasons as described in section 9. Four, update each tracker's next-deadline fields from the log. Five, send status updates to clients and co-op agents on files that moved or need input, so nobody learns about urgency from silence.

Time-box the review at about ten minutes per file. Six files take about an hour. The discipline is the same at any volume: every file, every Monday, in deadline order, ending with sent communications rather than private notes. A review that ends with sent messages moves files. A review that ends with mental notes repeats itself next Monday with older problems.

Assign ownership explicitly. In a solo practice, you are the owner with a backup procedure for vacation or illness: a broker or colleague who can open the tracker and see exactly what is due. In a coordinator

model, name who updates which sheet and by when each week. Reviews without owners decay within a month, and decayed reviews are how files with five-figure commissions quietly fall apart over a missed email.

15. Communication Routines That Prevent Surprises

Most deadline failures are communication failures wearing a calendar disguise. The fix is a small set of standard messages sent at fixed points: new file introduction to all parties with key dates stated, inspection scheduled notice, inspection report received notice with the objection deadline restated, appraisal ordered and received notices, weekly Friday status on every active file, commitment received notice, clear-to-close notice, and pre-closing confirmation with time, place, funds, and identification requirements. The message template in this kit covers the contingency status update shape, and the discipline is to send it before it is requested.

State dates in every message. A status update without dates is small talk. A status update that names the next three deadlines with dates and owners is file management. Restate the deadline even when everyone knows it, because known-to-everyone dates are exactly the ones nobody verifies. Confirm receipt of anything load-bearing: notices, funds, documents. A sent email without confirmed receipt is a hope where a proof is needed.

Keep tone professional and neutral in writing, especially when files strain. Blame in email hardens positions and gets forwarded. Facts with dates keep files moving and protect you if a timeline is ever reconstructed. Log every substantive call with date, party, and outcome in the contingency or checklist notes the same day. Memory of phone calls fades within days. Notes do not.

16. Post-Close Review Method

Within three business days of each closing, complete one Post-Close Review row while details are fresh. Record the contract and close dates, let the formula compute actual days to close, and write three short entries: what slipped, the lesson, and the follow-up action with its owner. What slipped means the deadline or document that caused the most stress, even if nothing was actually missed. Near misses teach as much as misses. The lesson means the one-sentence rule you will apply next time, for example request condo documents at acceptance rather than waiting for the listing agent. The follow-up action means the concrete change: template updated, checklist row added, lender note filed, or client education paragraph written.

Mark follow-up done only when the change exists, not when it is planned. A lesson without an implemented change is a diary entry. Quarterly, read all reviews together and count patterns: which contingency slips most, which lenders run late, which document is always last, which client segment needs the most education. Choose one process change per quarter from the patterns. One change per quarter compounds into a visibly calmer practice within a year.

The review also feeds referrals honestly. Thank-you notes, testimonial requests where appropriate and voluntary, and review-site guidance all belong in the follow-up action column when fitting. Never fabricate reviews, never pressure clients for ratings, and never offer anything of value conditioned on a positive review where your state rules restrict it. The review sheet tracks operations. Reputation follows operations that deserve it.

17. Illustrative Examples

Illustrative example 1: a solo agent with five active listings and purchases. Monday review shows one inspection objection deadline Friday, one appraisal review window closing Wednesday, and three files missing HOA documents. The agent sends the inspection notice draft to the broker Tuesday for review, well inside the window. The appraisal file gets a same-day call to the lender for the report status. HOA requests go out Monday with Thursday need dates and reasons stated. Friday closes with all three risks retired. All roles, numbers, and outcomes in this paragraph are illustrative.

Illustrative example 2: a transaction coordinator supporting two agents with eight files. The contingency log sorted by days remaining reveals two files with the same loan commitment date and different lenders. The coordinator forwards both condition lists same-day with concrete instructions, follows up before the need dates, and logs every exchange. One file clears, the other needs an extension negotiated before expiration with broker guidance logged. Both outcomes are managed rather than discovered. All roles, numbers, and outcomes in this paragraph are illustrative.

Illustrative example 3: post-close learning in action. Quarterly review of nine closed files shows the title commitment arriving late on four files from the same ordering pattern: ordered a week after acceptance instead of day one. The process change is a checklist rule requiring title order within 24 hours of acceptance, with the order confirmation logged. Next quarter shows the pattern gone. All roles, numbers, and outcomes in this paragraph are illustrative.

18. Frequently Asked Questions

Question: How many deals can this system handle. Answer: comfortably 2 to 10 active files for a solo user, more with a coordinator updating sheets on a fixed schedule. Beyond about 15 concurrent files, consider dedicated transaction management software and use this kit's review cadence and contingency discipline inside it.

Question: Does this replace my broker platform or transaction software. Answer: no. It complements those tools with a cross-file urgency view: every deadline across every file sorted by days remaining on one screen. Keep documents in your system of record and urgency in the tracker, or mirror both per office policy.

Question: What if my state counts days differently from the workbook. Answer: the workbook computes plain calendar math as a starting point. You apply your state and contract counting rules before entering each deadline date, as section 8 explains, and note the source. When forms update, re-verify the counting language.

Question: Can I use this for listings as well as buyer files. Answer: yes. The tracker and checklist work for either side. Contingency rows differ by side, so enter the contingencies your side must monitor: seller-side users track buyer contingency dates that affect the seller, plus seller obligations such as disclosures and repairs.

Question: What happens when a close date moves. Answer: update the close date cell the day the amendment is signed, recompute dependent expectations, confirm new dates with all parties in writing, and log the change. Stale close dates mislead every urgency judgment downstream.

Question: How do I handle a client who will not send documents. Answer: request in writing with a specific need date and the reason tied to a deadline, follow up before the date, escalate to your broker per office policy if the pattern threatens a contingency, and log every step. Documented diligence protects you even when the outcome disappoints.

Question: Should every contingency get its own log row. Answer: yes. Rows get flagged, sorted, and reviewed. Notes inside other cells get forgotten. The cost of a row is seconds.

Question: Is this kit legal advice. Answer: no. It is operations paperwork and general information. Contract interpretation, notice sufficiency, and deadline disputes belong to your broker or counsel. Verify your state contract rules locally before relying on any procedure here.

Question: How long do I keep closed-file records. Answer: follow your state retention rules and broker policy as the floor, commonly several years. Keep contingency notices and proof of delivery for at least that period. When in doubt, keep the file.

Question: What support is included. Answer: file and usage questions by email within 7 days of purchase, as described in the support field. Support does not include legal interpretation, contract review, or advice on any live transaction.

19. Limitations

This kit is not legal advice. Nothing here interprets contract language, judges notice sufficiency, or advises any party to exercise, waive, extend, or terminate any contingency. Contract forms, deadline-counting methods, notice and delivery rules, document requirements, and retention periods vary by state and change over time. Verify your state contract rules locally, follow your broker's policies, and consult a qualified attorney or your broker on any live question before acting. Procedures that are correct in one state can be wrong in another, and form revisions can change counting and notice rules without fanfare.

The workbook computes calendar math and flags. It does not verify your counting method, confirm delivery, or decide whether a contingency is satisfied. Dates entered incorrectly produce confident-looking flags that are wrong, so verify every deadline against the signed contract and addenda at entry. Photo and document checklists support completeness but cannot compel any party to deliver. Outcomes depend on consistent use, local rules, third parties, and facts outside any template's control.

20. Disclosure

Galaxy Forge sells this kit as a digital download: this guide, one Excel workbook with four sheets, and three Word templates. The purchase price covers those files and the usage guidance in section 2. It does not include legal services, broker supervision, transaction coordination on live files, or advice on any specific transaction. Support covers file and usage questions as described in the listing support field. No result of any kind is promised. Illustrative examples in section 17 are teaching sketches with illustrative numbers, not case studies, not reports of actual transactions, and not predictions. Not legal advice. Verify state contract rules locally.

21. Fourteen-Day Setup Plan

Day 1: read sections 1 through 8 and open the workbook. Day 2: enter all active deals in the tracker with verified contract and close dates. Day 3: enter every contingency deadline from signed contracts and addenda, with sources noted. Day 4: complete the document checklist for each file and send the first round of missing-document requests. Day 5: write your office day-counting card from section 8 and confirm it with your broker. Day 6: run the first full Monday-style review even if it is not Monday, and send every reminder it surfaces. Day 7: standardize your file naming and storage per broker policy and confirm backups. Day 8: review contingency notes for sub-milestones on inspection files and add specialist follow-ups. Day 9: confirm appraisal order dates and expected return dates in writing with each lender. Day 10: confirm loan condition traffic is dated and logged on every financed file. Day 11: send Friday-style status updates on all active files to practice the routine. Day 12: complete a practice post-close review on your most recent closing from memory and file notes. Day 13: review the week's sent communications for date discipline and tone. Day 14: run the full weekly review again, confirm every live deadline and document gap is captured, and lock the Monday appointment as recurring. From day 15 on, operate the weekly routine as written.

Appendix A. Formula and Column Reference

Deal Tracker: Deal ID, Property Address, Side, Contract Date, Close Date, Days To Close as close minus contract, Status, Next Deadline, Next Deadline Date, Priority. Contingency Log: Deal ID, Contingency Type, Deadline Date, Days Remaining as deadline minus today, Status via overdue and due-soon comparison with satisfied override, Date Satisfied, Notes. Copy the row-2 formulas down as you add rows. Document Checklist: Deal ID, Document, Required, Received, Date Received, Status flagging required-but-unreceived items as missing. Post-Close Review: Deal ID, Contract Date, Close Date, Days To Close as close minus contract, What Slipped, Lesson, Follow-up Action, Follow-up Done. All formulas use only standard spreadsheet functions and work identically in current versions of Excel, LibreOffice Calc, and Google Sheets with the file imported. Verify your state contract rules locally before relying on any computed deadline.